BRUTAL CEO OBJECTIONS: What They'll Really Say

Preparing for the Harsh Reality of Executive Pushback

THE HARSH TRUTH

You're asking for $3M + 9% + 30% + 9% equity from executives who've built billion-dollar empires. They didn't get there by giving away massive percentages to employees with ideas.

JIM ALLEN'S BRUTAL OBJECTIONS

"Who the hell are you?"

"You work at one of our properties and you want $3 million? I've been in gaming for 40 years. What makes you think you deserve more than our senior VPs who've been here for decades?"

Your Reality Check: You're a casino employee asking for CEO-level compensation. They'll see you as delusional.

"We can do this without you"

"Thanks for the idea, but we have a business development team. We can call Mattel ourselves. Why would we pay you millions for a phone call we can make?"

Your Reality Check: Once you give them the idea, they can cut you out completely.

"This is our intellectual property now"

"You developed this concept while employed by Seminole. Any gaming innovations belong to the company. You should be grateful we don't fire you for wasting time on side projects."

Your Reality Check: Employment contracts often claim ownership of employee innovations.

"9% of revenue? Are you insane?"

"Our senior executives don't get 9% of revenue. Our board members don't get 9% of revenue. You want more than people who've invested hundreds of millions?"

Your Reality Check: 9% of $50Mis$4.5M annually - more than most C-suite executives make.

MATTEL'S BRUTAL OBJECTIONS

"We don't need a middleman"

"Seminole can contact us directly. Why would we pay licensing fees to someone who doesn't own our IP? You're just a casino employee with an idea."

Your Reality Check: Mattel has no incentive to include you in their licensing deal.

"Prove the market demand first"

"Come back when you have actual gaming revenue data. We're not licensing our brand based on PowerPoint presentations and wishful thinking."

Your Reality Check: They want proven results, not projections.

"Our licensing fees are our business"

"Why would we share our licensing revenue with you? That's between us and Seminole. You're not a party to our agreement."

Your Reality Check: You have no legal standing in their licensing negotiations.

SEMINOLE TRIBAL COUNCIL OBJECTIONS

"This benefits you more than the tribe"

"You're asking for generational wealth while our tribal members get what? This looks like you're exploiting our gaming compact for personal gain."

Your Reality Check: Tribal gaming is about tribal sovereignty and member benefits, not enriching employees.

"We have fiduciary duties"

"We're responsible to 4,000+ tribal members. How do we justify giving one employee millions while tribal programs need funding?"

Your Reality Check: They have legal obligations to prioritize tribal interests over individual employees.

LEGAL TEAM OBJECTIONS

"This creates massive liability"

"If we give one employee 9% of gaming revenue, every employee with an idea will demand the same. This sets a dangerous precedent that could cost us hundreds of millions."

Your Reality Check: Legal teams exist to minimize risk and liability.

"Employment law issues"

"This could be seen as preferential treatment, creating discrimination claims from other employees. The NLRB could investigate our employment practices."

Your Reality Check: Large payouts to individual employees create legal exposure.

"Gaming regulation concerns"

"Gaming commissions scrutinize all revenue-sharing agreements. This could trigger regulatory investigations into our licensing and employment practices."

Your Reality Check: Gaming is heavily regulated, and unusual compensation arrangements draw scrutiny.

FINANCIAL TEAM OBJECTIONS

"The numbers don't work"

"$3M finder's fee plus 9$10M+ annually. We could hire 50 gaming executives for that cost."

Your Reality Check: CFOs focus on cost-benefit analysis, and your ask is expensive.

"ROI doesn't justify the cost"

"Even if UNO generates $50M annually, paying you 4.5M means we need $60M+ just to break even on your compensation. The math doesn't work."

Your Reality Check: They'll calculate whether your compensation exceeds the value you create.

"Opportunity cost analysis"

"For $3M upfront, we could develop 10 other gaming concepts internally. Why put all our eggs in one basket with one employee?"

Your Reality Check: They have multiple investment options for that capital.

OPERATIONAL OBJECTIONS

"Implementation risk"

"What happens when Mattel says no? What happens when players don't like it? What happens when it fails? You get paid regardless, but we lose millions."

Your Reality Check: You're asking for guaranteed payment while they take all the risk.

"You have no gaming development experience"

"Have you ever launched a casino game? Do you understand gaming regulations? Have you managed a $50M product rollout? Why should we trust you with this?"

Your Reality Check: They'll question your qualifications to execute what you're proposing.

"Staffing and training costs"

"New games require dealer training, floor supervision, marketing campaigns, and ongoing support. Those costs could exceed your projected revenues."

Your Reality Check: Implementation costs money, and they'll want detailed budgets.

COMPETITIVE OBJECTIONS

"First-mover advantage is temporary"

"Even if UNO works, competitors will copy it within months. Our advantage disappears quickly, but your payments continue forever."

Your Reality Check: Gaming innovations are quickly replicated by competitors.

"Market saturation concerns"

"How many people actually want to play UNO in a casino? The novelty might wear off in six months, leaving us with expensive tables nobody uses."

Your Reality Check: They'll question long-term market demand.

THE BRUTAL COUNTER-OFFERS

"Here's what we'll actually offer:"

Scenario 1: The Insult

"We'll give you a $10,000 bonus if this works out and maybe a promotion to table games supervisor."

Scenario 2: The Token

"$50,000 finder's fee and a consulting contract for 5,000/month for one year. Take it or leave it."

Scenario 3: The Trap

"We'll consider a revenue-sharing agreement after UNO proves successful for two years. But first, sign this NDA and non-compete."

Scenario 4: The Dismissal

"Thanks for the idea. We'll take it from here. Get back to work, and don't discuss this with anyone or you'll be terminated."

THEIR NUCLEAR OPTIONS

"We'll do it without you"

- Call Mattel directly
- Claim the idea as company property
- Develop it internally
- Cut you out completely

"We'll discredit you"

- "Employee overstepped boundaries"
- "Violated company policies"
- "Wasted company time"
- "Unrealistic expectations"

"We'll replace you"

- Transfer you to another property
- Reduce your responsibilities
- Create hostile work environment
- Force you to quit

HOW TO FIGHT BACK

Document Everything

- Email trails showing your initiative
- Timestamped research and analysis
- Proof of concept development
- All communications with management

Legal Protection First

- Hire gaming attorney BEFORE meeting
- File intellectual property claims
- Establish independent contractor status
- Create paper trail of value creation

Leverage Your Position

- You work there - you understand operations

- You have the Mattel connection strategy
- You've done the market research
- You can walk away and take it elsewhere

Alternative Strategies

- License the concept to competitors
- Develop it independently
- Partner with other gaming companies
- Create your own gaming consulting firm

REALISTIC NEGOTIATION STRATEGY

Phase 1: Establish Credibility

- Present comprehensive business case
- Show detailed implementation plan
- Demonstrate market research depth
- Prove you're serious, not just dreaming

Phase 2: Start High, Negotiate Down

- Open with aggressive terms
- Expect massive pushback
- Have fallback positions ready
- Know your walk-away point

Phase 3: Secure Something

- Get written agreement for ANY compensation
- Establish precedent for revenue sharing
- Protect against being cut out

- Build foundation for future negotiations

REALISTIC COMPENSATION EXPECTATIONS

Pessimistic Scenario:

- $25K-50K finder's fee
- 0.5% of revenue for 3 years
- Consulting contract for implementation
- No equity participation

Realistic Scenario:

- $100K-250K finder's fee
- 1-2% of revenue for 5 years
- $10K/month consulting for 2 years
- 1-3% equity in gaming venture

Optimistic Scenario:

- $500K-1M finder's fee
- 3-5% of revenue for 7 years
- 10-15% of licensing fees
- 5-7% equity participation

Your Dream Scenario:

- $3M finder's fee
- 9% of revenue for 10 years
- 30% of licensing fees
- 9% equity participation

Reality Check: Your dream scenario is probably 10x what they'll actually offer.

BOTTOM LINE TRUTH

They're going to try to lowball you, steal your idea, or cut you out entirely. That's what billion-dollar companies do to employees with ideas.

Your job is to: 1. **Protect yourself legally** before revealing everything 2. **Document your contribution** so they can't claim it's theirs 3. **Have alternatives ready** if they try to screw you 4. **Negotiate from strength**, not desperation 5. **Be prepared to walk away** if the deal isn't fair

Tuesday's meeting isn't about getting your dream deal - it's about not getting completely screwed while establishing your value in this opportunity.

Fight for every dollar, because they sure as hell won't give you anything out of kindness.